

Storey — Advisor Plan

A working list of who Storey wants on the advisor bench, why, and how to track the outreach. Update this in place as conversations happen.

Why advisors

An advisor opens **doors, judgement and credibility** you don't have yet — at roughly 1/100th the cost of a hire. For a founder building a B2B SaaS solo, two or three well-chosen advisors compound more than another developer would.

What you actually want from each: 30–60 minutes a month, intros to people you can't reach cold, and *honest* push-back on decisions.

Expertise to cover

You don't need one of each on day one. Aim for **2–3 first**, picked from the gaps that hurt most right now (distribution and credibility with contractors).

#	Area	What they bring	Why it matters for Storey
1	Construction industry — a contractor / project manager who has run real sites in NE India	Validates the product against reality, opens doors to other contractors	Your highest-leverage advisor type — distribution to your buyer
2	B2B SaaS founder/operator — someone who has built and <i>scaled</i> a B2B SaaS, ideally to SMBs	Product, pricing, GTM, hiring, fundraising playbook	Avoids 6-month mistakes a solo founder always makes
3	Local NE-India network — Assam/Meghalaya/Nagaland connections (real-estate, infra, govt)	Pilot sites, references, regulatory navigation	Your beachhead market
4	B2B sales / GTM to SMB	A channel and pricing playbook for selling to small contractors	Conversion is the hardest part, not the build
5	Legal / regulatory (India) — a CA / startup lawyer	Entity, DPDP, contracts, advisor agreements, IP	Cheap insurance against expensive mistakes
6	Finance / fundraising	Investor intros, deck feedback, term-sheet sanity-checking	Needed before a raise, not before

Tracking — outreach pipeline

Statuses: **Target** → **Reached out** → **Met** → **Engaged** → **Passed**

Name	Expertise area	Intro source	Status	Ask (time / equity)	Notes
Avinash Chirania — Founder, Architect, 4Line Designs	1 — Construction (+ also 3 — NE network)	<i>own contact</i>	Target	<i>tbd</i>	Architect-founder — strong site/process insight + a natural route to contractor introductions (his clients). Slot #1 priority.
	1 — Construction		Target		
	2 — B2B SaaS (SMB India)		Target		
	2 — B2B SaaS (SMB India)		Target		
Upmanyu Sharma — ERP Architect, London	7 — Technical / ERP architecture	<i>friend (own contact)</i>	Target	<i>tbd</i>	Enterprise ERP architecture lens: workflow engine, multi-tenancy, data model, audit/ledger patterns. Strong for <i>system design</i> questions as Storey scales — NOT for SMB-India GTM. Different role from slot #2; slot #2 still open.
	3 — NE network		Target		
	4 — Sales/GTM		Target		
	5 — Legal		Target		
	6 — Finance		Target		

Fill names in. Aim for **two candidates per slot** — most won't say yes, and you want the right one, not the first one.

Specific specializations to look for

Not just "*a construction person*" — these are the concrete profiles, ranked by real value to Storey today.

1 — Construction industry (*highest leverage right now*)

- **Active general contractor** running 3+ sites — feels the pain you're solving daily
- **Practising architect / PMC** overseeing multiple builds — sees the whole flow (Avinash fits)
- **Civil/site engineer** with 10+ yrs on site, ideally now in a management role
- **Real-estate developer** with multi-project ops (their site teams are your buyer)
- **Quantity surveyor** — for the BOQ/cost angle (only if you ever revive BOQ; long-term)

- **Avoid:** retired veterans 10+ yrs out — context is stale

2 — B2B SaaS that *actually* sells to SMBs in India

The skill you need is "sell software to small businesses who don't want software" — that's a *specific* operator profile.

- A **founder / first-10 operator** from Khatabook · OkCredit · Vyapar · Tally · Marg ERP · MyBillBook · ClearTax · Zoho (SMB lines)
- A **VP Product** or **Head of Customer Success** from any vertical SaaS that scaled in India (Drip Capital, Procol, Infra.Market — adjacent)
- **Ideal:** someone who has shipped Hindi/regional-language UI to small-business users — that's a hard-won lesson set
- **Avoid:** enterprise-only B2B operators (Salesforce alums etc.) — different game

3 — NE-India network

- A **respected contractor / developer** with PWD/RWD/govt work in Assam / Meghalaya / Nagaland
- A **CREDAI Assam** chapter member
- A **senior banker** at HDFC / SBI / Axis corporate banking, Guwahati branch
- An **IIT Guwahati / NIT** faculty member with industry links
- A **state PWD / urban-development** retired senior officer
- A **former head of an NE incubation centre** (IIM Shillong's incubator, IIT-G Technology Incubation, Assam Startup / Nest-i, Startup Mizoram, etc.) — one of the highest-leverage profiles for this slot: they sit on every founder/investor/govt/industry rolodex in the region at once
- Look for someone who can place a call and get a meeting — that's the asset

4 — B2B sales / GTM to SMB (*not "marketing"*)

- A **field-sales head** from Tally / Marg ERP / Vyapar — they cracked SMB selling
- A **channel-sales** operator who used dealer/CA networks to distribute SaaS
- A **sales-led pricing** specialist — contractors haggle; the pricing playbook matters
- **Avoid:** digital marketers / growth hackers — your buyer doesn't see ads

5 — Legal / regulatory (sequence matters)

- **CA (Chartered Accountant) FIRST** — entity registration, GST, tax, vendor contracts. Cheapest to engage.
- **Startup lawyer SECOND** — once you raise: equity, ESOP pool, term-sheet, FAST agreements
- **DPDP / data-privacy lawyer** — only when you cross 50k+ users or take enterprise contracts
- You don't need all three on retainer; one CA + one startup lawyer on call covers 90%

6 — Finance / fundraising

- An **active angel** with 5+ Indian SaaS investments in the past 3 years (not someone who invested once in 2018)
- An **ex-founder** who has *recently* closed a pre-seed or seed in India — the playbook changes yearly
- A **VC associate/principal** at an Indian early-stage fund — for the lens, not the money (yet)

- A **boutique investment banker** focused on early-stage tech / SaaS — useful for term-sheet negotiation, valuation sanity-checks, and (later) bridge/Series A process management. Not the same role as an angel: a banker runs the *process*, an angel writes the *cheque*. Only relevant at seed → Series A, not pre-seed. • **Avoid:** generalist M&A bankers (big-ticket only) and "fundraising consultants" charging % upfront with no track record • **Ideal:** someone who has closed 5+ Indian SaaS rounds in \$1–5M range in the last 2 years
- **Only relevant when you're <90 days from raising** — too early and they ghost; too late and you're behind

7 — Technical / architecture sounding-board (*useful, not urgent*)

- An **enterprise ERP architect** — workflow engines, multi-tenancy, audit/ledger patterns. Storey is becoming a vertical ERP; one good architect can prevent 6 months of avoidable mistakes (Upmanyu fits)
- A **principal engineer / CTO** from a multi-tenant SaaS — for scaling questions
- Not the same as slot 2 (which is *go-to-market*, not architecture)

Cross-cutting bonuses (not separate slots — added value if a candidate has them)

- **Hindi / Assamese** language fluency — for product UX feedback
- **Female advisor** for board balance and a different lens — actively under-represented in ConTech
- **Government procurement** experience — if you ever sell to PSUs or state-tied work

What to offer (norms, not rules)

- **Time:** 30–60 minutes a month, plus ad-hoc messages. Set the expectation up front.
- **Equity (typical): 0.1–0.5%** vesting over **2 years** with a 3-month cliff.
 - 0.1–0.25% — light advisor, intros + occasional call
 - 0.25–0.5% — heavy advisor, deeply involved
- **Cash:** usually zero for early-stage; sometimes a small monthly stipend for heavy advisors.
- **Paperwork:** a one-page **FAST Agreement** (Founder Advisor Standard Template from Founder Institute, free) — or the equivalent under Indian law, drafted by your CA / lawyer once you register the entity.
- **Get the entity registered first** — you can't grant equity from an unregistered business. (This is on the main TODO.)

Outreach playbook

1. **Warm beats cold, every time.** Use LinkedIn, your contacts, school/college networks. Ask for a 15-minute intro call, not "to advise" yet.
2. **The first message is short.** *"Building a site-operations app for NE-India contractors. Real product, live in beta with 2 testers. Would value 15 mins of your perspective on [specific topic they care about]. Can I send a link?"*
3. **Lead the meeting.** Have a one-page brief (what you're building, who for, what's working, what you'd want from them). Don't ask them what to do — show what you're doing and where you want their judgement.
4. **Ask after 2–3 calls**, not on the first. By then they've already invested time; the formal ask is small.
5. **Track every conversation in the table above.** A "no" today is a "yes" in 18 months.

What NOT to do

- Don't offer equity in the first message.
 - Don't hand out advisor slots cheaply — every diluted % matters, and an inactive advisor is a long-term tax.
 - Don't take advice without checking it against your own conviction. Advisors give context, *you* decide.
 - Don't recruit advisors for status. A famous name who never replies is worse than an unknown name who does.
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Next concrete step

Pick **two names you already have access to** for slots #1 (construction) and #3 (NE network). Send the 15-minute-intro message this week. Track [here](#).